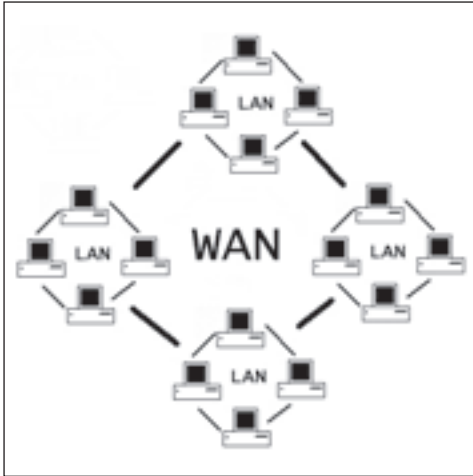


WAN (Wide area network)



Topology of WAN

Unlike LAN or WLAN, WAN spans a large area such as a city or a country. This is made possible by connecting smaller networks like LAN to each other. The best example of WAN is the internet, which is the world's biggest WAN. Besides the internet, large businesses and governments use WAN to relay information to their clients and colleagues.

MAN (Metropolitan area networks)

These networks span a large area like a city or a large campus. MANs usually interconnect a number of LANs and provide building blocks for WAN.

SAN (Storage area network)

SAN is a type of local area network (LAN) designed to handle large data transfers.

PAN (Personal area network)

This is your very own personal network. Personal area networks typically involve a mobile computer, a cell phone and/or a handheld computing device such as a PDA or an iPad. You can use the network to transfer files between your devices, sync your calendar etc. Personal area networks can be constructed with cables or wirelessly.

CAN (Controller area network)

This is a network of microchips which can communicate with each other without a host computer. It was designed specifically for automotive applications but is now also used in other areas such as industrial automation and medical equipment.